

Weekly internship Reflection

University of Niagara Falls

Master's in data Analytics

Internship information

Intern name: Abigia Gashahun Edossa

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Company Information

Company name: Food Truck Association of Canada (FTAC)

Internship job title: Data Science & AI pipeline engineer Intern

Internship Supervisor: Mackenzie Peck

Week 5 reflection: 9th February -13th February, 2026

During Week 5, I continued building on the work I completed in Week 4. Since Week 4 focused on cleaning, organizing, and encoding the dataset, Week 5 was about using that prepared data to train and test the machine learning model. Because I had already addressed the issue of too many posts being classified as mixed help and improved the labeling structure, the model training process was much more stable and meaningful.

This week, I trained a classification model using the cleaned **combined_text** column and the **ml_label** column I created earlier. I applied TF-IDF as part of the modeling pipeline so the system could learn from the most important words and phrases in each post. I then evaluated the model's performance to see how well it was separating startup posts from operational posts. By looking at prediction results and category distribution, I was able to see whether the imbalance problem from previous weeks had improved. This step helped confirm that the data preparation work from Week 4 was necessary and effective.

For Week 6, instead of trying to improve everything at once, I plan to focus on a few practical and achievable tasks. First, I will carefully review the model's errors to understand where it is still making mistakes, especially in cases that are close to being mixed. Rather than testing many different complex models, I will compare the current Logistic Regression model with just one alternative model, such as Linear SVM, to see if there is a meaningful improvement. I will also slightly adjust the TF-IDF settings, such as experimenting with different n-gram ranges, to see whether that improves performance.

Another important goal for Week 6 is to manually review a small sample of misclassified posts to check whether the issue is coming from weak features or unclear labeling. This will help ensure the dataset quality remains strong. Finally, I plan to organize the code into a cleaner, modular pipeline structure so that the preprocessing steps and trained model can be reused easily in future stages.

By keeping the goals focused and realistic, Week 6 will strengthen the model's reliability without becoming overwhelming. It will also help create a more stable foundation for future improvements and possible deployment.

Student signature:

A handwritten signature in black ink, consisting of a stylized 'A' followed by a cursive flourish.

Date: 13-02-2026